

household and business expenditures. To some extent, these data are explained by the lower cost of living and doing business in small towns. Yet even when cost of living is taken into account, auctioneers are more prone to accumulate wealth. Consider the following:

- ◆ On average, millionaire auctioneers are about fifty years of age, six to eight years younger than their urban/suburban counterparts.
- ◆ The average millionaire auctioneer spends only 61 percent of the amount urban/suburban millionaires allocate for housing.
- ◆ Urban/suburban millionaires are more than three times more likely than millionaire auctioneers to own luxury foreign automobiles.
- ◆ Auctioneers hold a higher proportion of their wealth in appreciating assets than do other high-income producers, and they invest in categories in which they have expertise.
- ◆ Auctioneers have experience with bankruptcy. They are aware that consumer goods often generate few cents on the dollar. One auctioneer explained why she was so frugal:

*When I was quite young, I watched a woman crying ... sitting on a chair in her front yard. All the while, bidders were walking away with everything she once owned. I'll never forget that woman.*

Let's ask the typical American self-made millionaire about her defense. We will refer to her as Mrs. Jane Rule. Mrs. Rule and her husband own a small business, an auctioneering/appraising company. They also invest in several of the categories of items they appraise. Mr. Rule is the visible manager of their business. He gets much of the credit for its success. After all, he speaks very well and very quickly. But it's actually Mrs. Rule who is the true force, the real leader, of this enterprise. It's her planning, designing, budgeting, bill collecting, and marketing that made this auctioneering company successful.

Why are Mr. and Mrs. Rule millionaires today? Because Mrs. Rule plays tremendous defense! She is responsible for budgeting and spending for both her household and their business. Is anyone in your household